

# ABBY BUCHANAN

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## **UX Researcher & Strategist**

Portland, OR

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## **SUMMARY**

UX researcher and strategist focused on how people experience systems under real-world conditions—cognitively, emotionally, and environmentally.

I study moments where people get stuck—overwhelm, ambiguity, and breakdown in task initiation—and translate behavioral insight into clearer, more usable systems. My practice builds on decades of client-centered inquiry, structured interviewing, behavioral observation, and systems-oriented design across physical and digital environments. Seeking research-focused roles within collaborative product teams, especially environments that value async work, qualitative depth, and ethical approaches to technology.

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## **CORE SKILLS**

Qualitative Research • User Interviews • Research Synthesis • Research Strategy  
Systems Thinking • Information Architecture • Journey Mapping • Accessibility  
Neurodivergent Design • Cross-functional Collaboration

Tools: Figma • FigJam • Miro • Notion • Google Workspace • Agile Environments

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## **EXPERIENCE**

### **Studio Manager (UX Systems & Operations) Amri Studio | 2022–2024**

- Redesigned inventory, organization, and information-flow systems within a complex studio environment
- Improved usability and accessibility of the physical workspace, supporting neurodivergent employees
- Developed workflows and communication systems to increase clarity and team alignment

**Freelance UX & Spatial Designer**  
**2019–Present**

- Conducted user-informed design for neurodivergent individuals, incorporating therapist input and individualized needs
- Designed sensory-informed and biophilic environments supporting regulation, clarity, and cognitive ease
- Designed curriculum for a multi-age pod-based homeschool, structuring content to support clarity and cognitive pacing

**Freelance Web Designer (UX-Focused)**  
**2019–Present**

- Designed websites with clear user flows, improving onboarding and booking experiences by translating client needs into structured digital systems
- Developed a structured client discovery framework combining analytical and intuitive inputs to translate abstract brand identity into clear, systemized design direction

**Founder & Owner**  
**Veda Collective | 2011–2019**

- Scaled a solo practice into a team of 5 practitioners
- Designed end-to-end client experience, including intake, booking flows, and service structure
- Conducted client interviews and translated behavioral insights into repeatable, user-centered service delivery

**Co-Owner & Systems Designer**  
**Resound NW | 2019–Present**

- Designed and iterated on studio environments across multiple locations
- Contributed to systems supporting students and instructors
- Supported operational and strategic decision-making

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**EDUCATION & TRAINING**

Human–Computer Interaction (HCI), Cornell University (eCornell)  
B.M. Music Composition (Tech Minor), Oral Roberts University  
Psychology of Home Design — Psychologie of Home